

The Best Advice I Ever Got

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Financial services company HDFC Securities is a subsidiary of HDFC Bank



‘Dig deep and focus on bigger goals’

What was the problem you were grappling with?

In March 2020, the Covid-19 pandemic struck us. I had to deal with uncertainties and numerous problems like the scalability of technology, the dichotomy of caring for colleagues [while] providing uninterrupted service to customers, risk management amid unprecedented volatility, and many more. On top of it, five senior management team members were unavailable due to family issues, resignation, retirement, etc.

Who did you approach for advice?

The predicament was manifested on my face. At least my father, Prem Sagar Relli, could read it well.

What was the advice you received?

He told me you cannot extract water by digging 10 holes of 4ft. each. Instead, you get water by digging deep, and where to dig deep is the starting point! In a simple example, I got my lesson to focus on the top two-three areas and get disproportionately better results. He also told me to keep focussing on bigger goals and building my

standards, while continuously trying to beat them. He explained this concept by referring to a winning horse in the derby who runs for his pride, and not that of the jockey's.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

Using my father's advice, I could not only prepare myself with more grit, but also found that it was driving results the way we aspired for as a company. **BT**

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

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